

NNA1

Planning, Implementing, Managing Instruction

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A seventh-grade science teacher whose room has a 70-gallon aquarium plans a lesson on photosynthesis for a class with many intermediate ELLs. The district adopted a new curriculum this year. Which plan best reflects SDAIE?

- A.** Teach the lesson in English exactly as for fluent students.
- B.** Replace photosynthesis with a simpler lesson on plant colors.
- C.** Have ELLs watch the aquarium plants while others do the lesson.
- D.** Teach photosynthesis with a labeled diagram, a hands-on leaf experiment, key vocabulary, and modeled explanations.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An observer sees a lesson in which ELLs learn the same grade-level fractions standard as peers, with manipulatives, gestures, and visuals. Which approach is this?

- A.** SDAIE (sheltered content instruction)
- B.** Home-language instruction
- C.** Pull-out ESL
- D.** Remedial math

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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3.

A fifth-grade class that meets after morning assembly will read a story about a snow day. Several ELLs recently arrived from tropical countries. The class library has 400 books. What should the teacher do first?

- A.** Pick a different book from the 400 so no one is confused.
- B.** Build background with photos and a short video of snow and a discussion linking it to weather students know.
- C.** Start reading; the story will explain snow.
- D.** Assume all students know about snow from TV.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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4.

A kindergarten newcomer in a room with a bright rug has been silent for three weeks but follows classroom routines. The class has 22 students. Which listening activity fits her stage?

- A. Assign a worksheet of written words.
- B. A Total Physical Response game: "Touch your nose," "Stand up," "Point to the red block."
- C. Ask her to answer questions aloud in full sentences.
- D. Wait until she speaks before including her.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student answers "Show me the circle" by pointing correctly but does not yet speak. What stage do these responses suggest, and what should the teacher expect next?

- A. Pre-production; expect one- or two-word answers to come next.
- B. No progress, since she does not speak.
- C. Intermediate fluency; expect full paragraphs next.
- D. A hearing problem; refer immediately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In a ninth-grade history class with new laptops, the same five fluent students answer every discussion question. The ELLs rarely speak. The class is reading about a famous trade route. Which change will most increase ELL talk?

- A. Ask more open questions to the whole class.
- B. Call on ELLs first without warning.
- C. Use think-pair-share with sentence frames like "One reason was ... because ..." and allow wait time.
- D. Have ELLs type their answers on laptops instead of speaking.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Before a science reading on ecosystems, a teacher who runs a garden club wants to pre-teach vocabulary to intermediate ELLs. The text has 1,200 words. Which set is best to pre-teach?

- A. No words, so students learn them from context
- B. Only rare terms like “chemoautotroph”
- C. About five words such as “ecosystem,” “depend,” and “compete,” with visuals and student-friendly definitions
- D. Every unfamiliar word in the text

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which word from a science text is the best example of a tier 2 (high-utility academic) word?

- A. chlorophyll
- B. analyze
- C. photosynthesis
- D. dog

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Fourth-grade ELLs in a class that just received new whiteboards must write their first persuasive paragraph. The school’s writing contest is in May. What sequence best supports them?

- A. Wait until May so they can enter the contest.
- B. Assign the paragraph as homework with no model.
- C. Have students copy the teacher’s model word for word.
- D. Model a persuasive paragraph, write one together, then have students write with an opinion-reason-example organizer and frames.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A teacher with a class of 28, including eight ELLs at different levels, plans a group project on local landmarks. The class is on the second floor. How should she group students?

- A.** Individual work only, since groups always leave ELLs out
- B.** Random groups with no roles
- C.** All eight ELLs in one group
- D.** Mixed-proficiency groups of four with defined roles and shared accountability

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A 15-year-old newcomer who loves drawing had about three years of schooling before arriving. He cannot yet read in his home language. His school has a large art studio. What does he need most?

- A.** English vocabulary only, since he already has academic skills
- B.** Art classes only until he learns English
- C.** Foundational literacy and academic skills taught with age-appropriate content and materials, along with English development
- D.** Placement in a kindergarten class

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two secondary newcomers arrive at the same time. One had continuous schooling and reads well in her home language; the other had interrupted schooling. Which statement best describes their needs?

- A.** The first can transfer her literacy and content knowledge into English; the second needs foundational literacy and academic skills as well.
- B.** Both need the same program, since both are newcomers.
- C.** The second will learn faster because he has less to unlearn.
- D.** Only the first needs English support.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A seventh-grade science teacher ~~whose room has a 70-gallon aquarium~~ plans a lesson on photosynthesis for a class with many intermediate ELLs. ~~The district adopted a new curriculum this year.~~ Which plan best reflects SDAIE?

Target word: SDAIE plan **Decides:** Grade-level content made comprehensible.

A	Adjacent category	Keeps content but drops modified delivery.
B	Dropped element	Drops grade-level content.
C	Camouflage	Excludes ELLs from the content.
D	Correct	Grade-level content with comprehensible delivery.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

An observer sees a lesson in which ELLs learn the same grade-level fractions standard as peers, with manipulatives, gestures, and visuals. Which approach is this?

Target word: name the approach from features (reverse) **Decides:** Grade-level content + comprehensible delivery in English.

A	Correct	Grade-level content taught in English with modifications.
B	Inverted operation	The lesson is taught in English.
C	Adjacent category	Pull-out focuses on English, usually outside content class.
D	Confusion set	Remediation lowers the level; this lesson keeps grade-level content.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A fifth-grade class ~~that meets after morning assembly~~ will read a story about a snow day. Several ELLs recently arrived from tropical countries. ~~The class library has 400 books.~~ What should the teacher do first?

Target word: building background **Decides:** Some students lack experience with snow.

A	Camouflage	Avoids rather than builds background.
B	Correct	Supplies the experience the story depends on.
C	Dropped element	Drops the background step.
D	Absolute language	Does not check or build background.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A kindergarten newcomer ~~in a room with a bright rug~~ has been silent for three weeks but follows classroom routines. ~~The class has 22 students.~~ Which listening activity fits her stage?

Target word: activity for the silent period **Decides:** She understands some English but is not yet speaking.

A	Adjacent category	Reading, not listening, and not matched to her stage.
B	Correct	Builds listening through physical responses with no pressure to speak.
C	Inverted operation	Demands speech before she is ready.
D	Dropped element	Drops input she can use now.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A student answers “Show me the circle” by pointing correctly but does not yet speak. What stage do these responses suggest, and what should the teacher expect next?

Target word: stage from behavior (reverse) **Decides:** Understanding without speech = pre-production.

A	Correct	Early production follows the silent period.
B	Absolute language	Comprehension is progress.
C	Confusion set	Too advanced for non-speaking learners.
D	Adjacent category	Correct pointing shows she hears and understands.

6. Answer C Concept 4

In a ninth-grade history class ~~with new laptops~~, the same five fluent students answer every discussion question. The ELLs rarely speak. ~~The class is reading about a famous trade route.~~ Which change will most increase ELL talk?

Target word: structured talk **Decides:** Open whole-class questions let fluent students dominate.

A	Dropped element	Drops the structure that brings in quieter students.
B	Adjacent category	Pressure without support raises anxiety.
C	Correct	Structure, frames, and time give every student a chance to talk.
D	Camouflage	Avoids speaking practice.

7. Answer C Concept 5

Before a science reading on ecosystems, a teacher ~~who runs a garden club~~ wants to pre-teach vocabulary to intermediate ELLs. ~~The text has 1,200 words.~~ Which set is best to pre-teach?

Target word: choose words **Decides:** A few key, high-utility words.

A	Dropped element	Context alone often fails ELLs on key words.
B	Adjacent category	Low-utility words that are not central.
C	Correct	Key to the text and useful across subjects.
D	Absolute language	Too many to learn well.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which word from a science text is the best example of a tier 2 (high-utility academic) word?

Target word: identify tier 2 **Decides:** Tier 2 words appear across subjects.

A	Confusion set	Tier 3: specific to one domain.
B	Correct	Used across many subjects and texts.
C	Inverted operation	Tier 3: a content-specific term.
D	Adjacent category	Tier 1: everyday basic word.

9. Answer D Concept 6

Fourth-grade ELLs in a class that just received new whiteboards must write their first persuasive paragraph. The school's writing contest is in May. What sequence best supports them?

Target word: scaffolded writing **Decides:** Model, share, then support independent writing.

A	Camouflage	The contest date does not decide instruction.
B	Dropped element	Drops the model and guided practice.
C	Adjacent category	Copying does not build composing skill.
D	Correct	Gradual release with supports.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A teacher with a class of 28, including eight ELLs at different levels, plans a group project on local landmarks. The class is on the second floor. How should she group students?

Target word: grouping **Decides:** Mixed proficiency with roles supports language use.

A	Absolute language	Well-structured groups include ELLs.
B	Dropped element	Drops structure; fluent students may take over.
C	Confusion set	Limits access to proficient models.
D	Correct	ELLs hear and use language with peers, and roles ensure participation.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A 15-year-old newcomer who loves drawing had about three years of schooling before arriving. He cannot yet read in his home language. His school has a large art studio. What does he need most?

Target word: SIFE needs **Decides:** Limited prior schooling and no home-language literacy.

A	Inverted operation	Assumes schooling he did not have.
B	Camouflage	His interest in drawing does not meet his academic needs.
C	Correct	Addresses gaps while respecting his age.
D	Adjacent category	Not age-appropriate.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

Two secondary newcomers arrive at the same time. One had continuous schooling and reads well in her home language; the other had interrupted schooling. Which statement best describes their needs?

Target word: compare needs (reverse framing) **Decides:** Home-language literacy transfers; interrupted schooling leaves gaps.

A	Correct	Prior schooling shapes what each student needs.
B	Absolute language	Ignores different educational histories.
C	Inverted operation	First-language literacy speeds English literacy.
D	Confusion set	Both need English development.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SDAIE keeps content at grade level	Specially designed academic instruction in English (SDAIE) teaches grade-level content in English and makes it comprehensible through delivery (visuals, modeling, hands-on work), not by lowering the content.	Watering down the curriculum or teaching an easier topic.	Planning a content lesson for intermediate ELLs.
2	Activating and building background	Connect new content to students' prior knowledge and experiences, and build missing background before the lesson depends on it.	Assuming background ELLs may not share, or skipping straight to the text.	A lesson that depends on cultural or experiential knowledge.
3	Listening for beginners: Total Physical Response	Beginners build listening comprehension by responding physically to commands before they are asked to speak.	Requiring spoken answers from pre-production learners.	A newcomer in the silent period.
4	Structured academic talk	Speaking grows through structured partner talk with sentence frames, assigned roles, and wait time.	Relying on open whole-class questions that fluent students answer.	Only a few students ever speak in discussions.
5	Pre-teaching high-utility vocabulary	Before reading, pre-teach a small set of words that are key to the text and useful across subjects (tier 2), using visuals and student-friendly definitions.	Pre-teaching long lists of rare words, or none.	Choosing which words to teach before a reading.
6	Scaffolded writing	Model the genre, write together, then have students write with frames and organizers, fading support over time.	Assigning independent writing with no model.	ELLs asked to write in a new genre.
7	Cooperative grouping	Heterogeneous groups with defined roles and shared accountability let ELLs use language with more proficient peers.	Grouping all ELLs together for every task, or grouping without roles.	Deciding how to group a class with mixed proficiency.
8	Students with interrupted formal education	Secondary newcomers with limited or interrupted schooling need foundational literacy and academic skills alongside age-appropriate content, not just English vocabulary.	Assuming a secondary newcomer is literate in the home language and only needs English.	An older newcomer with gaps in prior schooling.

Course scope (public description): Planning, Implementing, Managing Instruction focuses on a variety of philosophies and grade levels of English Language Learner (ELL) instruction. It includes the study of ELL listening and speaking, ELL reading and writing, specially designed academic instruction in English (SDAIE), and specific issues for various grade level instruction.